

Apple loses flavour with Adobe

Adobe has announced a new version of its video effects package After Effects 6, and video editing software Premiere Pro. In a significant development, the company said that Premiere will no longer be developed for Apple systems.

The new version of Premiere has been redesigned and developed from the ground up for Windows XP. Adobe's core audience of creative professionals are often Mac users. But recently it is showing increasing signs of supporting only Windows, with Apple developing a lot of tools which overlap with their products. Adobe's strongest competitor in the video editing market is Apple's own video editing tool Final Cut Pro.

Adobe and Apple are not at loggerheads though; they continue to have good relations. After Effects continues to enjoy good sales on the Mac, and Photoshop remains the de-facto for photo editing, with Apple even using it as a performance indicator at the launch of the G5.



snapshot

P2P utility Morpheus had **231,000** unique users for the week ending **July 6**; **iMesh** had **214,000** during the same period.

Source: Nielsen/NetRatings, InternetNews.com

The 64-bit monster ...playing spoilsport?

The G5 processor powering the latest Power Mac, developed jointly by IBM and Apple, runs at frequencies up to 2 GHz. Benchmarks provided by Apple indicate that the system, powered by dual G5 processors, is considerably faster than the fastest Pentium 4 based system or even a dual Xeon processor configuration.

But these benchmarks are being questioned around the world. The rival machine that was used here was a Dell Dimension 8300, running a Linux operating system. There is belief that the

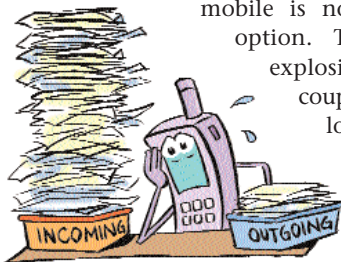


Dell score would have been much higher if the system was running a Windows operating system with an Intel optimised compiler rather than the used GCC compiler used.

All of this is pure speculation, for example, the performance of *Quake III Arena* on the system is reported to be much higher. However, other computers around the world easily match and outperform the score of the G5. But, then again, the G5 uses a 64 MB ATI Radeon 9600, in contrast to the 9800 Pro card with 128 MB memory used by the Dell Dimension 8300.

Increased cell phone usage due to free incoming calls

Under the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India's (TRAI) new Interconnect Usage Charge (IUC), or access charge regime, all incoming calls in India have been made free. This came into effect on the first of May, and since then talk times on cell phones have shown a 20 per cent jump. The introduction of WLL services has



also given a big boost to the total number of mobile users in the country, not only those adopting WLL, but also new users on the standard cellular (GSM) networks. Increased competition has pushed down prices and increased the total number of users on the networks. The new pricing structure also makes it more expensive in some cases to call

mobile phones on GSM networks from a standard fixed line. STD calls between mobiles are also cheaper than between fixed lines. So, for many users calling mobile to mobile is now the best option. This sudden

explosion of users, coupled with the longer talk times seems to have placed too much stress on the networks, with some users having to try a couple of times, before they can make a call or successfully send an SMS. Orange Vice President Harit Nagpal said, "Earlier, we used to handle traffic of about eight lakh SMS messages a day. Now the traffic has shot up five times with about four million SMS messages sent across our network alone."



heroes

Indian gamers

The gaming scene in India is beginning to heat up. Rumors of console systems such as the PS2 and Xbox are filling the scene. Along with this, new games are now available quite easily and legally. This is a great job done by members of the Indian gaming scene. Also, some credit goes to the gaming industry for testing out the waters of the Indian market, despite the piracy.

C-DAC

C-DAC's (Centre for Development of Advanced Computing) Param Padma Cluster is listed as one of the world's top 500 supercomputers. It is sitting at 171 on the list. The top 500 list, compiled by top500.org lists out 500 of the world's most powerful supercomputers based on raw computing power.



zeroes

Camera phone mischief

People are using camera phones to take unsolicited images. They are taking photographs of books and magazine pages that they need. In South Korea, where more than 3 million phones have cameras built-in, the problem is escalating. Samsung has banned camera phones in its offices to prevent industrial espionage.

Winamp3 Development stopped by AOL

AOL has stopped developing Winamp3, and will revert to its older version for now. The slow and buggy media player had shown promise in some areas, such as the homegrown language Wasabi. However, the upcoming Winamp5 (version 2 plus 3) will continue its development and should be out late 2003.